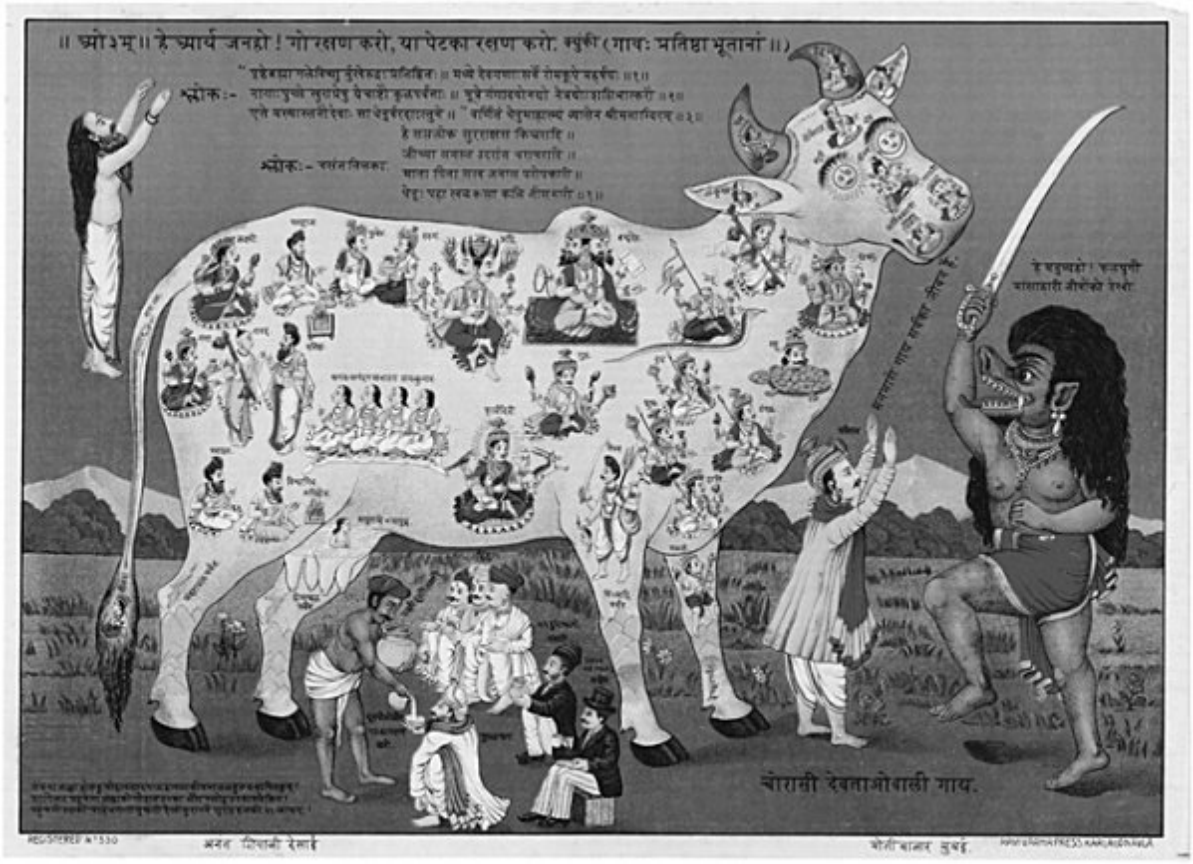
the indefatigable revolutionary Vinayak Damodar Savarkar, a Marathan Chitpavan Brahmin who had distinguished himself at the age of twelve by leading his schoolmates in an attack on his local mosque during Hindu-Muslim disturbances in the Nasik region in 1895. While studying law in London – where he met and profoundly disagreed with M. K. Gandhi – Savarkar examined the Italian nationalist Giuseppe Mazzini's role in the liberation and creation of modern Italy as well as the sepoy mutiny and uprising of 1857, leading to the publication in 1908 of his *History of the War of Indian Independence*, which was immediately banned by the British authorities.



One of Ravi Varma's immensely popular coloured lithographs, entitled *Chorsai devata auvai gaya*, or 'The cow with eighty-four gods'. It shows a good Hindu holding up his hands to prevent the demon Ravana from killing the sacred cow, while a cow-keeper nourishes a group of citizens of all ranks with milk.